

NIZAR LAHMAR

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity student (B.S., Jan. 2027) focused on security operations and detection. Built a segmented SOC lab with Wazuh SIEM and a fully documented, end-to-end attack chain; rooted 19 Hack The Box machines (rank: Skilled). Security+ and CySA+ certified; technical writeups at nizarlahmar.com.

Work eligibility: F-1 STEM OPT — up to 3 years of U.S. employment, no employer sponsorship required.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Operations & Detection: SIEM (Wazuh), Log Analysis, Threat Detection, Attack-Chain Analysis, Detection Engineering, Incident Documentation

Networking & Cloud: TCP/IP, DNS, Subnetting, Network Segmentation, Packet Capture, Azure VNets, NSGs, Load Balancing, IAM, SSO (OpenID), RBAC

Systems: Linux (daily — CachyOS, Kali, Ubuntu, Debian), Windows, Windows Server, Proxmox, QEMU/KVM

Tools: Burp Suite, Metasploit, Nmap, Nessus, Impacket, Gobuster, Wireshark, Git

Offensive Security: Web Application Exploitation, Privilege Escalation, Lateral Movement, Reconnaissance, Password Cracking, WiFi/WPS (Reaver), CVE Exploitation, PCAP Analysis

Development: C++ (C++17), Python, Bash, PowerShell, CMake, BSD Sockets, POSIX Threading

GRC: PCI-DSS, GDPR, Access-Control Policy, RBAC

Languages: English, French, Arabic (fluent)

PROJECTS

SOC Detection Lab | *Wazuh, QEMU/KVM, Burp Suite, DVWA, Linux* 2026

- Designed a segmented virtual network (DMZ + internal tiers) with Wazuh SIEM agents on every host, modeling a corporate monitoring environment on QEMU/KVM.
- Executed a full attack chain — file-upload web shell for initial access, sudo misconfiguration for privilege escalation, NIC misconfiguration for lateral movement, then anonymous FTP and credential reuse on internal targets — capturing the host and auth-log artifacts each stage produced.
- Engineered a custom Wazuh detection rule (mapped to MITRE T1505.003) flagging web-shell execution — GET requests for uploaded PHP files in DVWA's upload directory — layered on the default Apache ruleset and confirmed firing on live SIEM traffic.

C2 Framework (basic-c2) | *C++17, BSD Sockets, CMake, Linux* 2026

- Built a pull-based TCP C2 framework in C++17 directly on the BSD socket API (~600 LOC, no higher-level networking libraries): outbound-only agents poll a queue, execute commands, and return output — an agent-initiated model that minimizes inbound detection surface. Documented on GitHub.
- Implemented length-prefixed framing to handle partial TCP sends/receives, an XOR stream cipher for transport obfuscation, and POSIX threading with mutex-guarded session state; resolved a blocking-recv deadlock (agent awaiting a reply the server never sent) and rebuilt the console I/O loop to separate recurring beacon output from the operator prompt.
- Executed the implant on an internal host (simulating a drive-by delivery) and confirmed that beaconing and routine post-exploitation commands generated no Wazuh alerts under default rules; only incidental port-state changes surfaced, with no telemetry linking back to the operator — demonstrating the host-based monitoring gap against outbound-only C2.

CTF & Vulnerability Exploitation | *Hack The Box, TryHackMe, picoCTF, pwn.college* Ongoing

- Rooted 19 Hack The Box machines (rank: Skilled) plus TryHackMe and picoCTF challenges — exploiting SQLi, XSS, CSRF, SSTI, SSRF, LFI, Shellshock, race conditions, Jenkins Script Console RCE, misconfigured S3 buckets, and WPS/WiFi; publishing methodology writeups at nizarlahmar.com.
- Working through pwn.college (26 modules, 31 challenges solved), building assembly-level program analysis and gdb debugging.

Infrastructure Deployment & Hardening Lab | *Linux, Docker, Nginx, LAMP, Azure* 2025

- Deployed multi-VM web infrastructure (Rocky Linux + Ubuntu): Ghost CMS on Docker behind an Nginx reverse proxy and a full LAMP/WordPress stack with MySQL under least-privilege scoped accounts.
- Hardened the stack defense-in-depth (file permissions, protected `wp-config.php`, firewall controls) and provisioned segmented Azure VNets with NSGs, load balancing, and SSO (OpenID/RBAC); documented each control as vulnerability/configuration/validation.

GRC & Compliance Documentation | *PCI-DSS, GDPR, Active Directory, RBAC* 2025

- Authored audit-ready security policies for a simulated enterprise: credential lifecycle, ADUC-based reset workflows across five role types, exception handling, and enforcement escalation.
- Co-authored a PCI-DSS compliance policy — cardholder-data encryption at rest and in transit, RBAC/MFA, tokenization, log-retention, and CDE segmentation — with controls mapped to PCI-DSS and GDPR obligations.

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

Certifications: CompTIA A+, Security+, CySA+ | INE eJPT v2 | Cisco CCNA (in progress, exam Oct. 2026)

Full Sail University, Winter Park, FL — B.S. Cybersecurity (GPA 4.00), expected Jan. 2027; A.S. Information Technology (GPA 4.00), 2025.

EXPERIENCE

Full Sail University

Campus Tour Guide

- Led campus tours and live events for prospective students and families, communicating to varied audiences on a fixed schedule.

Winter Park, FL

Oct. 2025 – Present